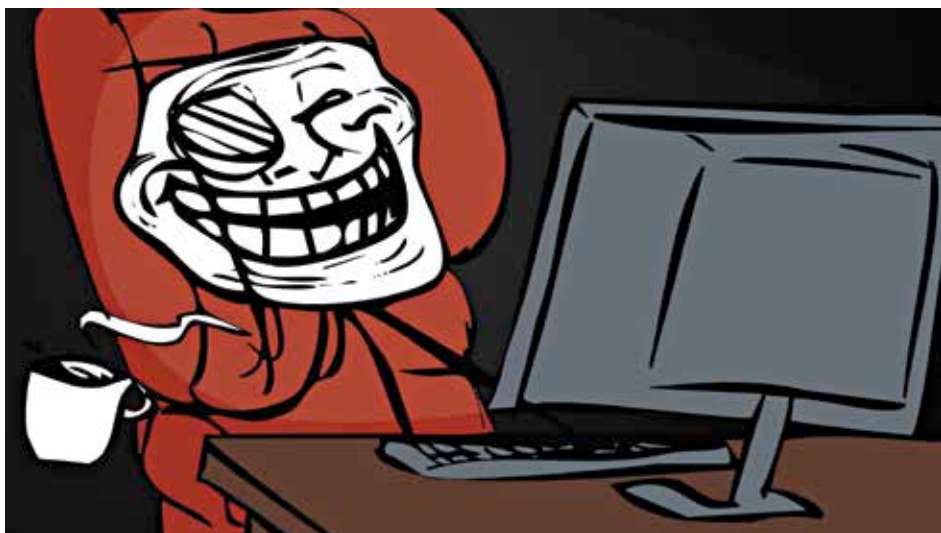




You've been bamboozled, tech-style!

Pranking your friends doesn't just have to be on April Fool's Day, does it?

Dhriti Datta |
dhriti@digit.in

WHO DOESN'T LOVE

PRANKS? Maybe the occasional wuss who got pranked diabolically in the past, but most of us can agree that, if executed perfectly, pranks are a great source of entertainment, at the expense of your unsuspecting victim. The best time to play pranks on your friends? NOT on April Fool's Day, since the surprise element is crucial to achieving pranking mastery. If you're a tech-savvy individual (or even if you're not, for some of these), it's time to dismiss some of the older classics such as Whoopee cushions

and chewing gum on a seat, and enter the league of techy pranksters who have a ton of fun while showing off their technical prowess. We've got some ideas...



GLITCHED ANDROID SCREEN

Developer options allow users to gain control over their Android device on a granular level. But you can also have some fun with it. All you need to do is grab a hold of your friend's phone for a minute



or two, maybe while she/he is off to the washroom, and activate developer options. To do this, head over to Settings > About Phone > Software Information > Build Number. Tap Build Number rapidly 5 times and you will be inducted into a group of a select few people that know about this hidden setting on their Android devices. Now you will be able to see Developer Options in your Settings menu under About Phone. Tap on it and scroll

down to 'Show Surface Updates', 'Show layout bounds' or 'Show GPU view updates'. Activating either of these will apply on-screen effects that resemble glitched screens. Lock the phone and give it back to your friend and watch them agonise over how to fix something they never knew exists... Yep, we're evil. Note: If you want an article dedicated to everything about Developer options on Android, let us know.



CHANGE TEXT AND APPS DIRECTION ON ANDROID

Left-to-right text is most prevalently used across the world and we underestimate how difficult and disorienting things can seem when they're switched the other way round. Grab your friend's phone and activate Developer options as directed above. Scroll down to 'Force RTL layout direction' and lo and behold! Everything on your friend's phone will switch to the right-to-left layout including text, apps stacking direction, apps menu scrolling direction and more. It will be bewildering and frustrating and absolutely hilarious for you!

